MKTG3112 Marketing Communications · Individual Essay

Alo in Australia – Reflection and Alternative Approach

Student number [ ]

Word count. Question One 727, Question Two 1195 (headings and body text, excluding figures, notes, prompts, references and appendices). Total 1,922

Question One – Evaluating "Mat to Moment"

1.1 Overall Assessment

Campaign effectiveness means achieving intended outcomes, not simply generating reach or likes (Belch & Belch, 2021). Against our four objectives, Mat to Moment is more likely to build store awareness (O3) than perceived worth (O1), despite our ranking O1 first (Appendix A). The objectives themselves are a strength because they are specific, measurable and linked to identified challenges (Colley, 1961). The weakness was how consistently our execution supported them.

1.2 Target Audience

Segment A, young women in Sydney who treat activewear as part of their identity, remains appropriate (Belk, 1988). However, financial pressure creates a tension our campaign did not resolve (Deloitte, 2026). At A$100–200 per item, Alo is positioned as "masstige" rather than luxury. These buyers buy more in categories they value while cutting back elsewhere (Silverstein & Fiske, 2003). We followed Kapferer and Bastien's (2009) argument that luxury needs meaning rather than justification. I now see that our audience also needs a reason to prioritise Alo, as guilt can suppress indulgent purchases unless the expense feels worthwhile (Okada, 2005).

1.3 Message Design

Our line, "From Mat to Moment", is clear, and its calm, after-class imagery contrasts with rivals' focus on sweat, suggesting creative divergence (Smith & Yang, 2004). However, moving from exercise to everyday wear defines athleisure (Merriam-Webster, n.d.), and our report shows that P.E Nation already promotes leggings this way (P.E Nation, n.d.). Therefore, the execution may stand out without making the proposition distinctive to Alo. Competitor attribution is a risk to our 60% brand-attribution target, although this requires testing.

Price justification is also underdeveloped. On bus panels and Instagram posts, “Worth it” is supported only by an “instructor-tested” label. Interested viewers might consider this relevant evidence, but without explaining what was tested, it may function mainly as a peripheral quality cue (Petty et al., 1983). More complete justification appears only on product pages, in stores, and at 36 sessions reaching a few hundred people. If the label works only as a peripheral cue, viewers may accept an impression of quality without understanding the premium. Such attitudes tend to be less enduring, less resistant to competing messages and less predictive of behaviour (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986). O1 therefore depends heavily on viewers reaching touchpoints that explain the premium.

1.4 Channel Selection

Outdoor receives A$55,000, or 22% of the budget, despite low audience selectivity (Belch & Belch, 2021). Store-route panels can support O3, but their limited price explanation makes their contribution to O1 less convincing. DataReportal reports potential advertising reach equivalent to 69.2% of Australian adults on Instagram and 51.2% on TikTok in late 2025, and women account for 54.8% of Instagram’s adult ad audience (Kemp, 2026). These figures establish potential scale, not efficient reach among Segment A, and cannot be added because audiences overlap. Instagram and TikTok allow the proposed creator videos to combine a fuller value argument with targeted exposure. Sydney audience estimates and campaign tests would determine the final allocation, rather than national reach alone.

1.5 Integration

Integration is our plan’s main strength. Every touchpoint carries the same line, set and sign-off, while hooks and calls to action vary, creating consistency without identical executions (Batra & Keller, 2016). However, our objectives assumed Vaughn’s (1980) feel–learn–do order, in which people feel something about a fashion brand before weighing facts, yet our AIDA journey delays the more complete price argument until Desire in Burst 2 (Strong, 1925). With that argument concentrated in lower-reach touchpoints, viewers could learn where to find Alo without understanding why it is worth the premium. Consistent presentation therefore does not ensure that activities support our priorities.

1.6 Likely Effectiveness and Measurement

O3 is most likely to succeed because store-location information is repeated across touchpoints. O2 is plausible because Sydney sources add local relevance (Sichtmann et al., 2019). O1 remains at risk, potentially weakening O4 if viewers lack a reason to visit. Evaluation is also limited. Only paid social, representing 21% of spend, uses randomised holdouts. The remaining activity relies on before-and-after comparisons, which can overstate advertising effects (Gordon et al., 2019).

1.7 What I Would Change

I would retain our audience, objectives, Sydney sources and consistent brand codes, but bring price justification into high-reach advertising. I would also develop a more distinctive branded idea and shift spending from outdoor and sessions towards Instagram and TikTok. Question Two develops these changes.

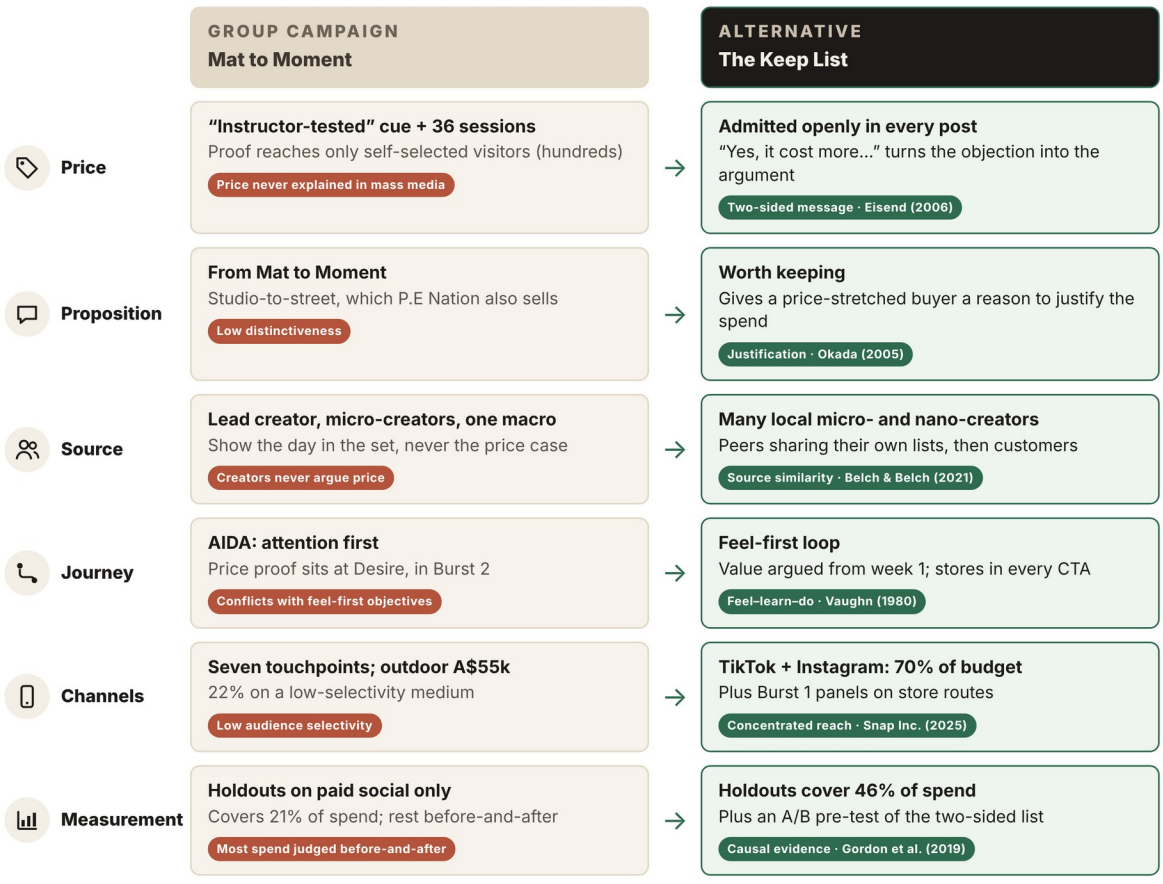
Question Two – An Alternative Approach, “The Keep List”

2.1 What I Changed and Why

The Keep List retains Segment A, objectives O1–O4, Sydney sources and consistent brand codes, while addressing the weaknesses identified in Question One (Figure 1). Perceived worth remains the highest-ranked objective, but now leads the creative strategy rather than relying on explanations in lower-reach touchpoints.

Figure 1

What Changes From the Group Campaign



Note. Weaknesses come from Question One, and tags show the main source justifying each change.

2.2 Audience and Insight

I retain Segment A because its identity-driven buying fits Alo (Belk, 1988). The unresolved price tension calls for a stronger value argument, not a different audience. In 2024, “loud budgeting”, openly naming what you will not spend on, spread on TikTok as a statement of choice (Axios, 2024). My insight is that what financially pressured young women choose to keep can express their identity as clearly as what they cut. Alo’s premium all-day positioning remains, but is expressed as “worth keeping” rather than “studio to street”. For prospective buyers, existing owners’ choices provide reasons to consider Alo, rather than simply keep garments already owned.

2.3 Message, Persuasion Route and Sources

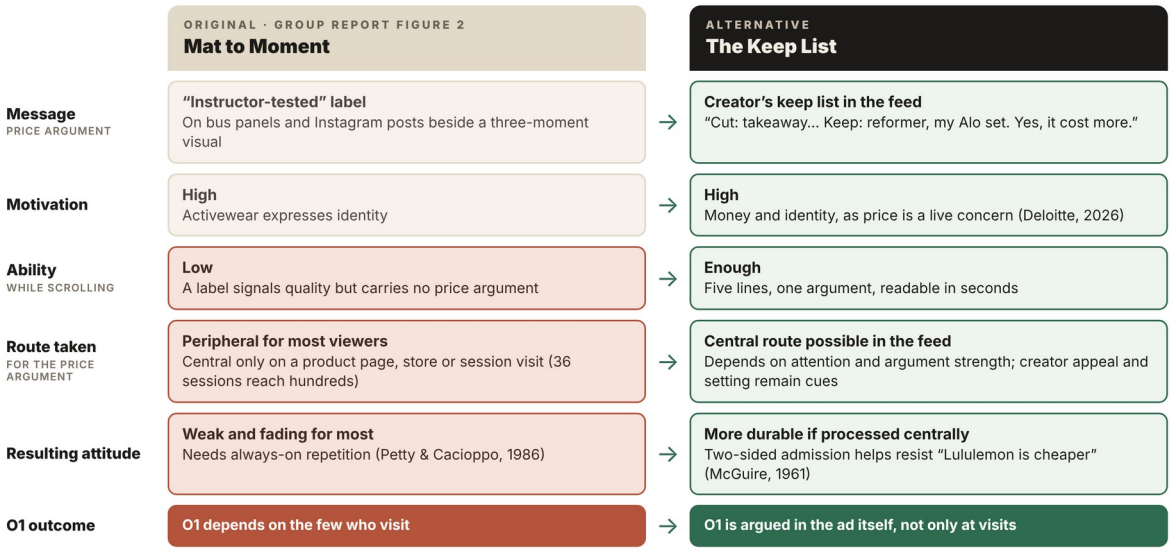
Our original message praised quality without explaining price. Mine is two-sided, with creators acknowledging the premium before explaining why Alo is worth keeping. This admission can strengthen credibility, although Eisend’s (2006) meta-analysis shows that persuasion depends on how negative information is presented, not simply whether it is included. They then explain how frequent wear makes the expense worthwhile (Okada, 2005). The list draws on mental accounting, where consumers organise spending into separate budgets (Thaler, 1999; Appendix B), without discounts that could weaken Alo’s premium positioning (Kapferer & Bastien, 2009).

However, frequent wear alone could justify any activewear brand. Creators must show their actual Alo garment across different occasions and explain the specific reasons they repeatedly choose it over alternatives. For example, a creator could explain the fit or styling she personally prefers, supported by footage of her own set. These reasons must come from genuine experience, not scripted claims about untested performance. This makes Alo the subject of the explanation, rather than attaching its logo to a general spending argument.

Under the Elaboration Likelihood Model, careful consideration requires motivation and ability (Petty et al., 1983). The Keep List brings the explanation into the ad itself (Figure 2). Financial pressure makes price relevant, while the short list makes the reasoning easy to follow. This creates an opportunity for consideration, not a guarantee of central processing, as attention, involvement and argument strength still matter.

Figure 2

Elaboration Likelihood Model, Before and After



Note. Adapted from Petty et al. (1983) and the group report's Figure 2.

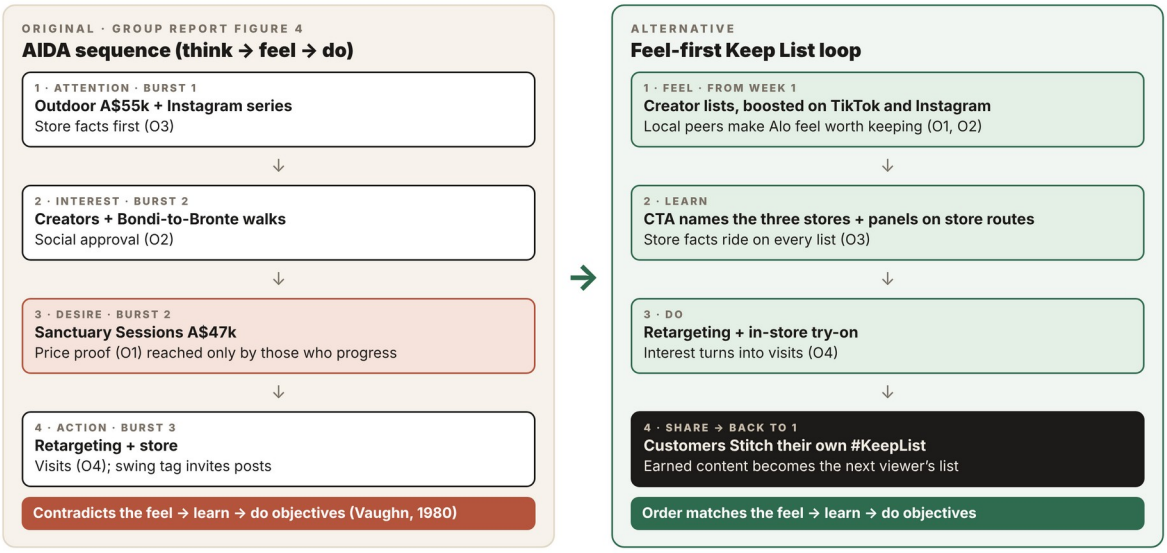
Sydney micro- and nano-creators introduce the format, with customers then invited to share their own lists. Their similarity to the audience can build trust (Campbell & Farrell, 2020). However, follower count alone is insufficient, so selection would prioritise Sydney audience relevance, credible Alo use and willingness to discuss the price honestly. The repeated list format, Alo wordmark and "Worth keeping" sign-off give these individual stories a consistent identity (Sharp, 2010).

2.4 Journey

Figure 3 uses Vaughn's (1980) feel–learn–do model as a planning guide, rather than assuming every viewer follows a fixed sequence (Appendix C). Each list connects Alo with personal priorities, explains the creator's choice (O1, O2), and names the stores (O3). Retargeting encourages engaged viewers to visit (O4), while try-ons offer some reassurance lost when sessions are removed. Customer Stitches can become another viewer's first exposure, linking advocacy back to discovery (Court et al., 2009). Paid boosts and brand reshares connect paid, owned and earned activity around the same value argument (Stephen & Galak, 2012).

Figure 3

Consumer Journey, Before and After



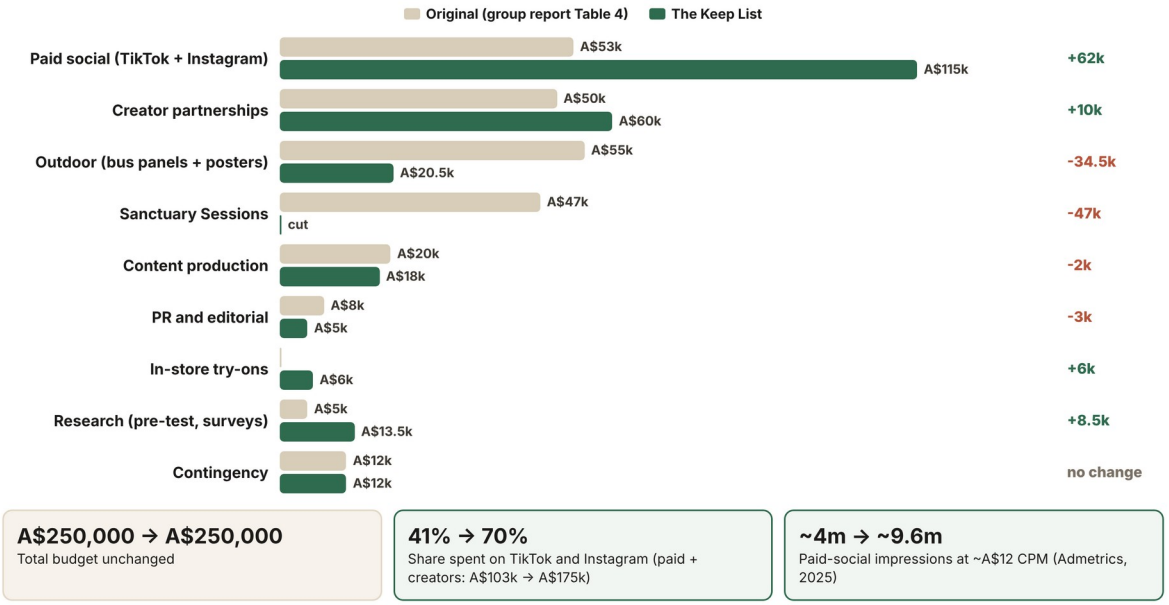
Note. Adapted from Strong (1925), Vaughn (1980), Court et al. (2009) and the group report's Figure 4.

2.5 Channels and Budget

Within A$250,000 (Figure 4), I remove Sanctuary Sessions (A$47,000) and reduce outdoor from A$55,000 to A$20,500, retaining Burst 1 panels on store routes. Paid social and creator partnerships rise from A$103,000 to A$175,000, or 70% of the budget. At an assumed A$12 per thousand impressions (Admetrics, 2025), A$115,000 in paid social could generate approximately 9.6 million impressions. This is a planning scenario, not proof of greater effectiveness.

Figure 4

Budget Reallocation Within A$250,000



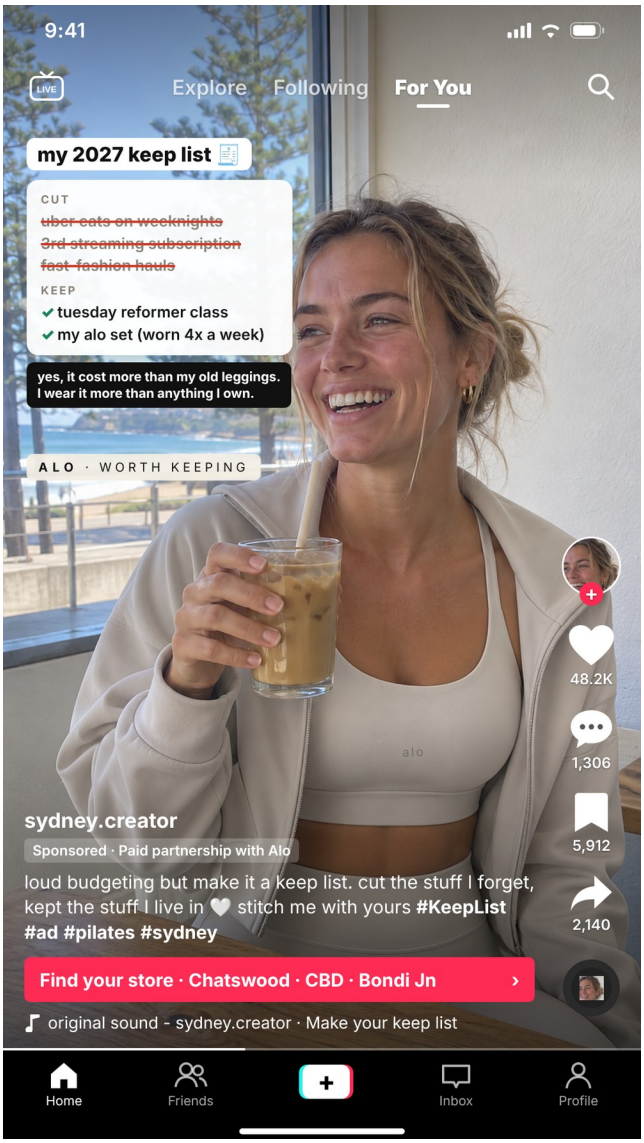
Note. Original figures are from the group report's Table 4. Bus panels cover 20 panels for three weeks at GoTransit (n.d.) rates plus production, with A$4,000 for posters. Creators cover about 100 micro and nano posts at A$150–750 each (Wise, 2025).

A pre-test would compare one-sided and two-sided messages on perceived worth and brand attribution (Belch & Belch, 2021). Randomised holdouts would assess paid-social effects on perceived worth and store-visit intention, covering 46% of spend rather than 21% (Gordon et al., 2019; Appendix D). Store-locator clicks and visit data would add indicators of actual visits, though not causal ones.

2.6 Creative Mock-up

Figure 5

“The Keep List” TikTok In-Feed Creator Post (Burst 1)



Note. AI-generated photograph composed into a TikTok frame. The person is not real, and the handle and engagement figures are illustrative. AI prompts used. (1) Photograph, generated with [name the image tool you used], using the prompt “Photorealistic vertical 9:16 smartphone photo that looks like a still from an iPhone TikTok video, not a professional shoot. A woman in her mid-twenties sits at a small timber table by the window of a casual café in Bondi, Sydney, around 9am, just after a reformer Pilates class. She wears a matching Alo Yoga–style set: a sleek, smooth sculpting sports bra and high-waisted leggings with a subtle sheen, in a soft neutral ‘bone’ colour, with an oversized cropped zip jacket in the same colour open over it. Clean, minimal, premium design. Do not render any text or logos on the clothing. Natural, unretouched skin, minimal makeup, hair in a slightly messy low bun, small gold hoop earrings. She is laughing naturally while holding an iced oat latte and looking just off camera. Soft morning sunlight comes through the window, with the ocean and Norfolk pines faintly visible and out of focus behind her. Handheld phone-camera look: slight

grain, true-to-life colour, shallow depth of field. Composition: she sits in the right half of the frame, shown from the waist up, with her face about 45% of the way down the image. Keep the upper-left third and the bottom quarter visually quiet so text overlays can sit there. No text, logos, watermarks or other people in focus." (2) TikTok frame, composed with Claude (Anthropic), using the prompt "Place this photo in an accurate TikTok For You in-feed Spark Ad frame (1080 × 1920 px) with the status bar, LIVE/Explore/Following/For You tabs, right-hand rail (creator avatar with follow button, likes, comments, saves, shares, sound disc), 'Sponsored · Paid partnership with Alo' under the handle, the caption with #KeepList and #ad, a red call-to-action button 'Find your store · Chatswood · CBD · Bondi Jn' and the sound line. Add native TikTok text overlays in the empty window area: 'my 2027 keep list', a Notes-style list (CUT: uber eats on weeknights; 3rd streaming subscription; fast-fashion hauls, struck through; KEEP: tuesday reformer class; my alo set (worn 4x a week)), the aside 'yes, it cost more than my old leggings. I wear it more than anything I own.' and an 'ALO · WORTH KEEPING' sticker. Add a small, correctly spelled 'alo' wordmark on the sports bra. Keep every overlay clear of her face."

Media format. Figure 5 represents a 15-second TikTok Spark Ad, with the list appearing line by line alongside the creator's voice-over. Boosting the creator's original post retains her handle and comments (TikTok for Business, n.d.-a), keeping her visibly attached to the explanation.

Message. The lowercase headline "my 2027 keep list" resembles a personal note and introduces the proposition within three seconds (TikTok for Business, n.d.-b). The price admission introduces the objection, while "worn 4x a week" leads into the creator's explanation of why this Alo set earns repeated use. This persuades because it borrows the loud-budgeting format the audience uses (Axios, 2024), so the price case arrives as a peer's reasoning rather than a sales claim. "Alo. Worth keeping." then ties it to the brand.

Imagery. The creator wears the matching set in a beachside Sydney café after class. This establishes the local setting (O2), while brief clips of the same garment across her week would support the frequent-wear claim. Natural light and a handheld style aim to convey authenticity (Francis & Hoefel, 2018), rather than making the post resemble a polished brand shoot.

Design. Native TikTok text makes the list familiar, while strikethroughs and ticks make choices easy to scan. The mock-up shows the list concept, while the video would reveal items progressively rather than display every claim at once. Alo's neutral palette and wordmark maintain brand recognition. "Paid partnership" and #ad identify the commercial relationship (Australian Association of National Advertisers [AANA], 2021; Wojdynski & Evans, 2016).

Call to action and engagement. "Find your store" names Chatswood, the CBD and Bondi Junction, linking the explanation to a practical next step (O3, O4). The caption invites viewers to Stitch their own lists, connecting participation with the advocacy loop in Figure 3. Each reply reaches the

poster's own network, and 88% of consumers trust recommendations from people they know most (Nielsen, 2021).

AI limitations. The AI-generated photograph is too polished for the intended phone-footage style, and audiences often find artificial personas uncanny and "authentically fake" (Lou et al., 2023), weakening believability. The mock-up also does not reliably reproduce Alo's garments or logo, and one slim model cannot show the range of bodies in our segment, weakening relevance to the audience. Actual posts would need real creators wearing Alo and honestly explaining their use and spending choices, rather than presenting the fictional creator's claim as evidence (Competition and Consumer Act 2010 (Cth) sch 2 s 18).

2.7 Advantages, Limitations and Expected Effectiveness

The Keep List brings price justification into high-reach advertising. However, cutting other spending to justify premium leggings could appear tone-deaf, particularly alongside café and Pilates imagery. Creators must present personal choices, not imply viewers should sacrifice necessities for Alo (Sher, 2011). Removing sessions also reduces hands-on proof. Overall, I expect stronger support for O1 and O2, while O3 remains supported. O4 depends on whether credible, Alo-specific explanations give prospective buyers enough reason to visit, not simply whether the campaign generates more impressions.

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Appendix A

Figure A1

Evaluation of "Mat to Moment" Against Its Objectives

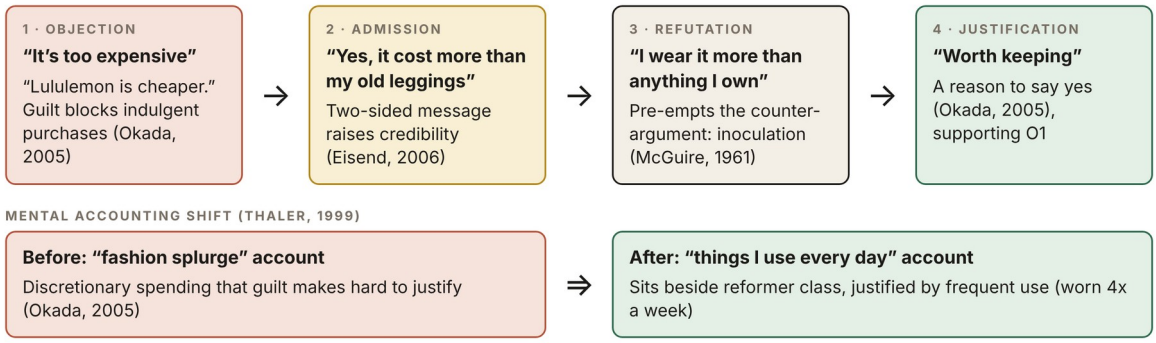
Objective	Main mechanism in the group plan	Evaluation	Likely outcome
O3 Learn: aware of Sydney stores (25% → 35%)	Store names on outdoor (A$55k) and the Instagram series in Burst 1	A simple fact suits peripheral learning (Petty et al., 1983); repetition builds memory (Keller, 2001)	Likely Strongest objective
O2 Feel: "a brand for people like me in Sydney" (12% → 18%)	Sydney instructors, creators and settings re-encode the LA brand	Localness adds relational value, even for global brands (Sichtmann et al., 2019)	Possible
O1 Feel: "worth paying more for" (15% → 21%)	"Instructor-tested" cue on reach media; proof in sessions, product pages and stores	Cue never explains price; central route reaches self-selected visitors only (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986); guilt unaddressed (Okada, 2005)	At risk Top priority, weakest mechanism
O4 Do: visited store or site (8% → 11%)	Retargeting, session bookings, store CTAs	Behaviour follows attitude (Vaughn, 1980), so depends on O1	Uncertain

Note. My evaluation, supporting Question One.

Appendix B

Figure B1

Two-Sided Message Structure, Inoculation and Mental Accounting

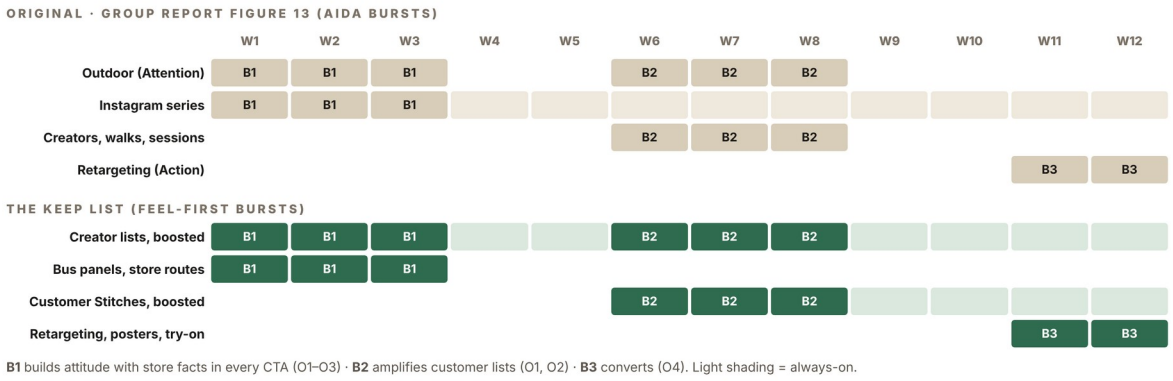


Note. Adapted from Eisend (2006), McGuire (1961), Okada (2005) and Thaler (1999).

Appendix C

Figure C1

Pulsing Schedule, Before and After

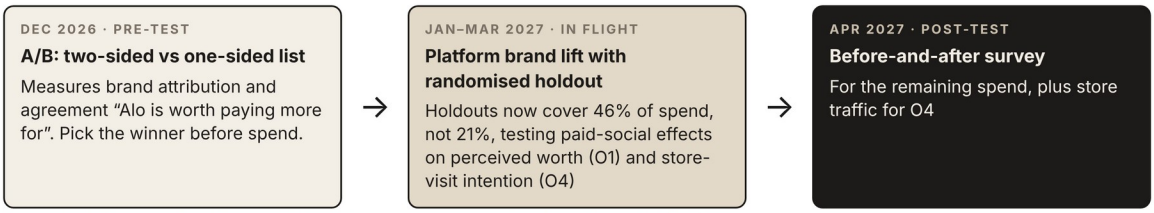


Note. Adapted from the group report's Figure 13, with pulsing from Belch and Belch (2021).

Appendix D

Figure D1

Pre-Testing, In-Flight and Post-Testing Plan



Pre- and post-testing stages from Belch and Belch (2021); randomised holdout rationale from Gordon et al. (2019).

Note. Adapted from Belch and Belch (2021) and Gordon et al. (2019).